

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Flood cleanup & mold

RECOVERY / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Do not enter an unsafe flooded building. Check structural, electrical, gas and contamination hazards before cleanup. Keep children and vulnerable people away, use suitable protection and stop if the work exceeds what can be done safely.

Do now.

- ☐ **Confirm safe entry**
01 Do not enter standing water near electrical equipment or a structurally damaged building. Qualified assessment may be needed before work begins.
- ☐ **Separate clean and dirty areas**
02 Create a clean place for drinking water, first aid and rest outside the work area. Keep flood-contaminated shoes and tools away from household supplies.
- ☐ **Use suitable protection**
03 Wear protective boots, gloves and eye protection. Mold cleanup may need a properly fitting NIOSH-approved N95 or better respirator; it does not protect against gases.
- ☐ **Dry and clean safely**
04 When safe, remove contaminated porous materials that cannot be cleaned and dry affected areas promptly. Follow product labels; never mix bleach with ammonia or other cleaners.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Keep the area isolated if equipment, clean water or safe entry cannot be obtained. Document damage from a safe location and prioritize drinking water, sanitation and a clean sleeping space. Delaying unsafe cleanup can be safer than entering without protection.

Watch for.

Do not run a generator indoors or in a garage during cleanup. Avoid working alone in unstable structures. Respirators need correct fit and do not make an unsafe building safe.

People & practical needs.

People with asthma, lung disease or weakened immunity should avoid mold cleanup when possible. Keep children, pets and food away from contaminated materials

Next decision.

Seek specialist advice for major contamination, sewage, structural damage or persistent mold. Keep disposal rules and insurer documentation in mind without delaying urgent protective action.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

INCIDENT / SYMPTOM ONSET / LOCATION

HELP REQUESTED / RESPONSE CONFIRMED

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

[CDC – Disaster cleanup safety](#)

[CDC – Reentering a flooded home](#)

[CDC – Mold cleanup supplies](#)

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/flood-cleanup/>